HOW TO WRITE THAT

Winning CV / Résumé

CV Writing

CSE 3200 | Technical Writing

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What makes a winning CV?

CORE

The core idea from the source deck

Be concise

- Keep information short and simple
- Organize information clearly
- Make important points easy to find

Be relevant

- Research the position and organization
- Match your qualifications to the requirements
- Highlight relevant strengths and skills

Be credible

- Be honest
- Use formal writing
- Show achievements and capability

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The 30-Second Scan

CORE

An employer may quickly look for a few key signals

30 SEC

Your CV must work quickly.

- Concise and well-organized information
- Clearly identified strengths and skills
- Qualifications that match the position
- Correct punctuation
- Correct spelling
- Correct grammar

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Follow this principle

CORE

Simple is easier to read and easier to evaluate

KEEP IT

SHORT & SIMPLE

Remove information that does not help the reader understand your qualifications.

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Be honest. Be formal.

CORE

Two basic writing rules emphasized in the source

BE HONEST

- Never write anything tricky
- Incorrect information can damage your chances
- Present your qualifications truthfully

BE FORMAL

- Use a professional writing style
- Never show an informal approach in writing
- Keep your presentation professional

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Research the position first

CORE

A strong CV starts with understanding the target

BEFORE WRITING

- Research the position and organization
- Get the job description, if possible
- Identify what the employer is looking for
- Use that information to decide which qualifications to highlight

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Match your qualifications

CORE

Do not give every detail equal importance

EMPLOYER NEED		YOUR CV
Position requirements	→	**Matching qualifications**

- Highlight strengths and skills that fit the position
- Show relevant qualifications rather than unrelated details

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Show achievements

CORE

The source emphasizes what you are capable of doing

WEAK FOCUS

- Only listing duties
- Repeating routine responsibilities
- Giving no evidence of capability

STRONGER FOCUS

- Show what you achieved
- Show what you are capable of doing
- Connect experience with professional skills

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Résumé formats

FORMATS

Three formats discussed in the source slides

Chronological

- Reverse chronological order
- Good with solid work history
- Widely accepted by employers

Skill-based / Functional

- Focuses on functional skill areas
- Highlights major skill areas
- Work history may be brief

Combination

- Combines skills and experience
- Uses relevant and/or other experience
- Appropriate for recent graduates

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Chronological format

Education and work experience appear in reverse chronological order

- Experiences are listed from most recent to oldest
- Dates including month and year should be included
- Describes educational and work experience
- Emphasizes career growth
- Highlights job title
- Easy to read

EXAMPLE ORDER

2026 → 2025 → 2024 → 2023

Most recent experience comes first.

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When to use chronological format

And when the source says not to use it

GOOD CHOICE WHEN

- Job history shows growth
- Career direction is clear
- Career direction directly matches work history

AVOID WHEN

- Work history is spotty
- Changing career goals
- There are gaps in employment

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Skill-based / Functional format

This format highlights qualifications and skills

- Concentrates on functional skill areas related to the job objective
- Usually focuses on three or more skill areas
- Can de-emphasize jobs
- Useful for highlighting transferable skills
- Can emphasize a particular skill strength

2–5

main skill areas

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Functional format: strengths & limits

Use it when the skills story is stronger than the job-history story

ADVANTAGES

- De-emphasizes jobs
- Decreases responsibility repetition
- Useful for career changers
- Highlights transferable skills
- Can de-emphasize less-related positions

DO NOT USE WHEN

- You have performed a limited number of functions
- You want to emphasize promotions

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Combination résumé

Chronological + skill-based

SKILLS + **EXPERIENCE**

- Combines a reverse chronological work history with a preceding summary of functional skills
- Emphasizes relevant job skills and qualifications early
- Can separate experience into “Related Experience” and “Other Experience”
- Source identifies it as especially appropriate for recent graduates

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Start with identifying information

Expected at the top of the résumé

- Use your full name
- Provide a contact address where you can be reached
- Give permanent address only if necessary
- Include relevant phone numbers
- Use a professional e-mail address

CONTACT BLOCK

- Full name
- Contact information
- Professional e-mail
- Reachable address

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Use professional contact details

The source gives a clear contrast for e-mail addresses

PROFESSIONAL

name@gmail.com

UNPROFESSIONAL

crazy@gmail.com

Your contact information should support a professional first impression.

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Job Objective

An optional section that gives direction and focus

WHAT IS IT?

A statement indicating what kind of position you are looking for and what you want to do for the organization.

It gives direction and focus to the résumé.

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How to state a Job Objective

The source identifies several possible components

POSITION

- Position you want to work at

SKILLS

- Skills you wish to use

FUNCTIONS

- Functions you wish to do

SECTOR

- Sector where you wish to work
- Or combine several elements

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Personal Statement

An alternative to the Job Objective

A BRIEF STATEMENT ABOUT:

- The type of person you are
- Your skills and achievements
- Your current situation
- Your professional expertise
- Your most important qualification
- Your most relevant skills for the job

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What should a Personal Statement answer?

Use these questions to keep it focused

1. What type of person are you?
2. What are you doing currently?
3. What is your professional expertise?
4. What is your most important qualification?
5. What are your most relevant skills?

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Education section

Include the key academic information clearly

CORE INFORMATION

- Full name of degree
- Duration
- CGPA
- Full name of university

ALSO POSSIBLE

- Relevant coursework
- Project work
- Research connected to the qualification

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How to order Education

Keep institutions in reverse chronological order

ORDER

Most recent → oldest

- List institutions in reverse chronological order
- High school becomes irrelevant once you possess more education
- As relevant experience increases, education becomes less important
- Experience may therefore appear before education

EDUCATION

↓

EXPERIENCE

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Experience section

EXPERIENCE

Experience is more than paid employment

- List experience in reverse chronological order
- Include position title, organization, location and dates
- Use bullets to describe experience
- Use action verbs
- Avoid repetitive statements such as “responsibilities included…”

EXPERIENCE CAN INCLUDE

- Jobs
- Volunteer work
- Class projects
- Internships
- Part-time work
- Training / workshops

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Write experience with action verbs

EXPERIENCE

Turn activities into clear evidence of skills

SOURCE EXAMPLES

Organized and scheduled tutor sessions for 50 students.

Designed practice exercises to help tutees problem solve.

ACTION VERBS

Organized
Designed
Motivated
Supervised
Developed

Show what you did — and, where possible, what it achieved.

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Transferable skills + final CV check

FINAL

Finish by checking content, format and presentation

TRANSFERABLE SKILLS

- Organizational
- Interpersonal
- Managerial
- Communication
- Leadership
- Analytical
- Creative
- Computer

APPEARANCE

- Maximum 2 pages preferred
- Readable professional font
- Avoid fancy fonts
- Bold/capitalize section headings
- Use bullets
- Avoid unnecessary artwork/photos
- Keep spacing consistent

FINAL CHECK

- Proofread for spelling
- Check grammar and punctuation
- Make sure it is typed
- Highlight relevant skills
- Tailor CV to the employer
- Update your CV

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